

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 1

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

001. Chapter 1 Summary

VERSE 1.1

धृतराष्ट्र उवाच ।
धर्मक्षेत्रे कुरुक्षेत्रे समवेता युयुत्सवः ।
मामकाः पाण्डवाश्चैव किमकुर्वत सञ्जय ॥१॥

dhṛitarāshtra uvācha
dharma-kṣhetre kuru-kṣhetre samavetā yuyutsavaḥ
māmakāḥ pāṇḍavāśhchaiva kimakurvata sañjaya

dhṛitarāshtraḥ uvācha—Dhritarashtra said; **dharma-kṣhetre**—the land of dharma; **kuru-kṣhetre**—at Kurukshetra; **samavetāḥ**—having gathered; **yuyutsavaḥ**—desiring to fight; **māmakāḥ**—my sons; **pāṇḍavāḥ**—the sons of Pandu; **cha**—and; **eva**—certainly; **kim**—what; **akurvata**—did they do; **sañjaya**—Sanjay

Dhritarashtra said: Having assembled on the holy plain in Kurukshetra desirous of fighting the battle, what did my people and the Pandavas do? O Sanjaya!

VERSE 1.2

सञ्जय उवाच ।
दृष्ट्वा तु पाण्डवानीकं व्यूढं दुर्योधनस्तदा ।
आचार्यमुपसङ्गम्य राजा वचनमब्रवीत् ॥२॥

sañjaya uvācha
dr̥ṣṭvā tu pāṇḍavānīkaṁ vyūḍhaṁ duryodhanastadā
āchāryamupasaṅgamyā rājā vachanamabravīt

sanjayaḥ uvācha—Sanjay said; **dr̥ṣṭvā**—on observing; **tu**—but; **pāṇḍava-anīkam**—the Pandava army; **vyūḍham**—standing in a military formation; **duryodhanaḥ**—King Duryodhan; **tadā**—then; **āchāryam**—teacher; **upasaṅgamyā**—approached; **rājā**—the king; **vachanam**—words; **abravīt**—spoke

Sanjaya said: On seeing the Pāṇḍava army arrayed for battle, King Duryodhana went to his teacher and spoke these words:

पश्यैतां पाण्डुपुत्राणामाचार्य महतीं चमूम् ।
व्यूढां द्रुपदपुत्रेण तव शिष्येण धीमता ॥३॥

*paśhyaitām pāṇḍu-putrāṇām āchārya mahatīm chamūm
vyūḍhām drupada-putreṇa tava śhiṣhyeṇa dhīmatā*

paśhya—behold; **etām**—this; **pāṇḍu-putrāṇām**—of the sons of Pandu; **āchārya**—respected teacher; **mahatīm**—mighty; **chamūm**—army; **vyūḍhām**—arrayed in a military formation; **drupada-putreṇa**—son of Drupad, Dhrishtadyumna; **tava**—by your; **śhiṣhyeṇa**—disciple; **dhī-matā**—intelligent

O teacher, behold the great army of the sons of Pāndu arrayed by your talented disciple, the son of Drupada.

अत्र शूरा महेष्वासा भीमार्जुनसमा युधि
युयुधानो विराटश्च द्रुपदश्च महारथः ॥४॥
धृष्टकेतुश्चेकितानः काशिराजश्च वीर्यवान् ।
पुरुजित्कुन्तिभोजश्च शैब्यश्च नरपुङ्गवः ॥५॥
युधामन्युश्च विक्रान्त उत्तमौजाश्च वीर्यवान् ।
सौभद्रो द्रौपदेयाश्च सर्व एव महारथाः ॥६॥

*Tatra śhūrā mahēshvāsā bhīmā-rjuna-samā yudhi
yuyudhāno virāṭaśhcha drupadaśhcha mahā-rathaḥ
dhṛiṣṭaketuśhchekitānaḥ kāśhirājaśhcha vīryavān
purujit kuntibhojaśhcha śhaibyaśhcha nara-puṅgavaḥ
yudhāmanyuśhcha vikrānta uttamaujāśhcha vīryavān
saubhadro draupadeyāśhcha sarva eva mahā-rathāḥ*

atra—here; **śhūrāḥ**—powerful warriors; **mahā-iṣhu-āsāḥ**—great bowmen; **bhīma-arjuna-samāḥ**—equal to Bheem and Arjun; **yudhi**—in military prowess; **yuyudhānaḥ**—Yuyudhan; **virāṭaḥ**—Virat; **cha**—and; **drupadaḥ**—Drupad; **cha**—also; **mahā-rathaḥ**—warriors who could single handedly match the strength of ten thousand ordinary warriors; **dhṛiṣṭaketuḥ**—Dhrishtaketu; **chekitānaḥ**—Chekitan; **kāśhirājaḥ**—Kashiraj; **cha**—and; **vīrya-vān**—heroic; **purujit**—Purujit; **kuntibhojaḥ**—Kuntibhoj; **cha**—and; **śhaibyaḥ**—Shaibya; **cha**—and; **nara-puṅgavaḥ**—best of men; **yudhāmanyuḥ**—Yudhamanyu; **cha**—and; **vikrāntaḥ**—courageous; **uttamaujāḥ**—Uttamauja; **cha**—and; **vīrya-vān**—gallant; **saubhadraḥ**—the son of Subhadra; **draupadeyāḥ**—the sons of Draupadi; **cha**—and; **sarve**—all; **eva**—indeed; **mahā-rathāḥ**—warriors who could single handedly match the strength of ten thousand ordinary warriors

In that army are mighty archers and heroes, in battle equal to Bhima and Arjuna:

Yuyudhāna, Virāta, and Drupada, each a mahāratha; Heroic Dhrishtaketu, Chekitāna, and the king of Kāśi; Purujit, Kuntibhoja, and Śaivya, all the best of men; Powerful Yudhāmanyu, brave Uttamaujā, Subhadra's son, and the sons of Draupadi - all mahārathas indeed.

अस्माकं तु विशिष्टा ये तान्निबोध द्विजोत्तम ।
नायका मम सैन्यस्य संज्ञार्थं तान्ब्रवीमि ते ॥७॥

*asmākaṁ tu viśhiṣṭā ye tānnibodha dwijottama
nāyakā mama sainyasya sanjñārthaṁ tānbravīmi te*

asmākam—ours; tu—but; viśhiṣṭāh—special; ye—who; tān—them; nibodha—be informed; dwija-uttama—best of Brahmins; nāyakāh—principal generals; mama—our; sainyasya—of army; sanjñā-arthaṁ—for information; tān—them; bravīmi—I recount; te—unto you

(Having named some of the foremost heroes of the Pandava Army, Duryodhana mentions the names of warriors on his side) O best of the twice-born, let me also recount to you the leaders of my own army, those distinguished amongst ourselves. I shall name them, that you may know them all:

भवान्भीष्मश्च कर्णश्च कृपश्च समितिञ्जयः ।
अश्वत्थामा विकर्णश्च सौमदत्तिस्तथैव च ॥८॥
अन्ये च बहवः शूरा मदर्थे त्यक्तजीविताः ।
नानाशस्त्रप्रहरणाः सर्वे युद्धविशारदाः ॥९॥

*bhavānbhīṣmaścha karṇaścha kṛpaścha samitiñjayaḥ
aśvatthāmā vikarṇaścha saumadattis tathaiva cha
anye cha bahavaḥ śhūrā madarthe tyaktajīvitāḥ
nānā-śhastra-praharaṇāḥ sarve yuddha-viśhāradāḥ*

bhavān—yourself; bhīṣmaḥ—Bheeshma; cha—and; karṇaḥ—Karna; cha—and; kṛpaḥ—Kripa; cha—and; samitim-jayaḥ—victorious in battle; aśvatthāmā—Ashvatthama; vikarṇaḥ—Vikarna; cha—and; saumadattiḥ—Bhurishrava; tathā—thus; eva—even; cha—also; anye—others; cha—also; bahavaḥ—many; śhūrāḥ—heroic warriors; mat-arthe—for my sake; tyakta-jīvitāḥ—prepared to lay down their lives; nānā-śhastra-praharaṇāḥ—equipped with various kinds of weapons; sarve—all; yuddha-viśhāradāḥ—skilled in the art of warfare

Yourself and Bhishma and Karna; Kripa, who is ever victorious in war; Ásvatthāmā, Vikarna, Jayadratha, and Somadatta's son; And many other heroes besides, armed with many weapons, each well skilled in battle, and all resolved to lay down their lives to serve my cause.

अपर्याप्तं तदस्माकं बलं भीष्माभिरक्षितम् ।
पर्याप्तं त्विदमेतेषां बलं भीमाभिरक्षितम् ॥ 10 ॥

aparyāptam tadasmākaṁ balaṁ bhīṣhmābhirakṣhitam
paryāptam tvidameteṣāṁ balaṁ bhīmābhirakṣhitam

aparyāptam—unlimited; **tat**—that; **asmākam**—ours; **balam**—strength; **bhīṣhma**—by Grandsire Bheeshma; **abhirakṣhitam**—safely marshalled; **paryāptam**—limited; **tu**—but; **idam**—this; **eteṣhām**—their; **balam**—strength; **bhīma**—Bheem; **abhirakṣhitam**—carefully marshalled

(Having named the various warriors on both sides Duryodhana now declares that his own army is superior.) But this army of ours, protected by Bhishma, is unlimited, and that army of theirs, protected by Bhima, is limited.

अयनेषु च सर्वेषु यथाभागमवस्थिताः ।
भीष्ममेवाभिरक्षन्तु भवन्तः सर्व एव हि ॥ 11 ॥

ayaneṣhu cha sarveṣhu yathā-bhāgamavasthitāḥ
bhīṣhmamevābhirakṣhantu bhavantaḥ sarva eva hi

ayaneṣhu—at the strategic points; **cha**—also; **sarveṣhu**—all; **yathā-bhāgam**—in respective position; **avasthitāḥ**—situated; **bhīṣhmam**—to Grandsire Bheeshma; **eva**—only; **abhirakṣhantu**—defend; **bhavantaḥ**—you; **sarve**—all; **eva hi**—even as

Now take your proper places in front of your marshalled troops and protect Bhishma alone.

तस्य सञ्जनयन्हर्षं कुरुवृद्धः पितामहः ।
सिंहनादं विनद्योच्चैः शङ्खं दध्मौ प्रतापवान् ॥ 12 ॥

*tasya sañjanayan harṣham kuru-vṛiddhaḥ pitāmahaḥ
sinha-nādam vinadyochchaiḥ śhaṅkham dadhmau pratāpavān*

tasya—his; **sañjanayan**—causing; **harṣham**—joy; **kuru-vṛiddhaḥ**—the grand old man of the Kuru dynasty (Bheeshma); **pitāmahaḥ**—grandfather; **sinha-nādam**—lion’s roar; **vinadya**—sounding; **uchchaiḥ**—very loudly; **śhaṅkham**—conch shell; **dadhmau**—blew; **pratāpa-vān**—the glorious

Bhishma the grandsire, the glorious, the oldest of the Kurus, gave forth a lion-roar and blew his conch, causing joy to Duryodhana.

ततः शङ्खाश्च भेर्यश्च पणवानकगोमुखाः ।
सहसैवाभ्यहन्यन्त स शब्दस्तुमुलोऽभवत् ॥ 13 ॥

*tataḥ śhaṅkhāścha bheryaścha paṇavānaka-gomukhāḥ
sahasaivābhyahanyanta sa śhabdastumulo ’bhavat*

tataḥ—thereafter; **śhaṅkhāḥ**—conches; **cha**—and; **bheryaḥ**—bugles; **cha**—and; **paṇava-ānaka**—drums and kettledrums; **go-mukhāḥ**—trumpets; **sahasā**—suddenly; **eva**—indeed; **abhyahanyanta**—blared forth; **saḥ**—that; **śhabdaḥ**—sound; **tumulaḥ**—overwhelming; **abhavat**—was

(Following the example of Bhishma, other heroes blew the conches, and drums, trumpets, and horns were sounded.) Then conchs and kettle-drums, tabors and trumpets and cow-horns suddenly blared forth; and the sound was stupendous.

ततः श्वेतैर्हयैर्युक्ते महति स्यन्दने स्थितौ ।
माधवः पाण्डवश्चैव दिव्यौ शङ्खौ प्रदध्मतुः ॥ 14 ॥

tataḥ śhvetairhayairyukte mahati syandane sthitau
mādhavaḥ pāṇḍavaśhchaiva divyau śhaṅkhau pradadhmatuḥ

tataḥ—then; **śhvetaiḥ**—by white; **hayaiḥ**—horses; **yukte**—yoked; **mahati**—glorious; **syandane**—chariot; **sthitau**—seated; **mādhavaḥ**—Shree Krishna, the husband of the goddess of fortune, Lakshmi; **pāṇḍavaḥ**—Arjun; **cha**—and; **eva**—also; **divyau**—Divine; **śhaṅkhau**—conch shells; **pradadhmatuḥ**—blew

Whereupon Mādhava and Pāṇḍava, seated in their magnificent chariot yoked to white horses, also blew their celestial conchs.

पाञ्चजन्यं हृषीकेशो देवदत्तं धनञ्जयः ।
 पौण्ड्रं दध्मौ महाशङ्खं भीमकर्मा वृकोदरः ॥ 15 ॥
 अनन्तविजयं राजा कुन्तीपुत्रो युधिष्ठिरः ।
 नकुलः सहदेवश्च सुघोषमणिपुष्पकौ ॥ 16 ॥
 काश्यश्च परमेष्वासः शिखण्डी च महारथः ।
 धृष्टद्युम्नो विराटश्च सात्यकिश्चापराजितः ॥ 17 ॥
 द्रुपदो द्रौपदेयाश्च सर्वशः पृथिवीपते ।
 सौभद्रश्च महाबाहुः शङ्खान्दध्मुः पृथक् पृथक् ॥ 18 ॥

*pāñchajanyam hrīṣhikeśho devadattam dhanañjayah
 paunḍram dadhmau mahā-śhaṅkham bhīma-karmā vṛikodarah
 anantavijayam rājā kuntī-putro yudhiṣṭhirah
 nakulaḥ sahadewaścha sughoṣha-manipuṣhpakau
 kāśhyaścha paramaeshvāsaḥ śhikhaṇḍī cha mahā-rathaḥ
 dhṛiṣṭadyumno virāṭaścha sātyakiḥ chāparājitaḥ
 drupado draupadeyaścha sarvaśhaḥ pṛithivī-pate
 saubhadraścha mahā-bāhuḥ śhaṅkhāndadhmuh pṛithak pṛithak*

pāñchajanyam—the conch shell named Panchajanya; **hrīṣhika-īśhaḥ**—Shree Krishna, the Lord of the mind and senses; **devadattam**—the conch shell named Devadutta; **dhanañ-jayah**—Arjun, winner of wealth; **paunḍram**—the conch named Paundra; **dadhmau**—blew; **mahā-śhaṅkham**—mighty conch; **bhīma-karmā**—one who performs herculean tasks; **vṛika-udarah**—Bheem, the voracious eater; **ananta-vijayam**—the conch named Anantavijay; **rājā**—king; **kuntī-putrah**—son of Kunti; **yudhiṣṭhirah**—Yudhishtir; **nakulaḥ**—Nakul; **sahadevaḥ**—Sahadev; **cha**—and; **sughoṣha-manipuṣhpakau**—the conche shells named Sughosh and Manipushpak; **kāśhyaḥ**—King of Kashi; **cha**—and; **parama-iṣhu-āsaḥ**—the excellent archer; **śhikhaṇḍī**—Shikhandi; **cha**—also; **mahā-rathaḥ**—warriors who could single handedly match the strength of ten thousand ordinary warriors; **dhṛiṣṭadyumnaḥ**—Dhrishtadyumna; **virāṭaḥ**—Virat; **cha**—and; **sātyakiḥ**—Satyaki; **cha**—and; **aparājitaḥ**—invincible; **drupadaḥ**—Drupad; **draupadeyaḥ**—the five sons of Draupadi; **cha**—and; **sarvaśhaḥ**—all; **pṛithivī-pate**—Ruler of the earth; **saubhadraḥ**—Abhimanyu, the son of Subhadra; **cha**—also; **mahā-bāhuḥ**—the mighty-armed; **śhaṅkhān**—conch shells; **dadhmuh**—blew; **pṛithak pṛithak**—individually

Hrishikeśa blew His conch, the Pāñchajanya; Dhananjaya, the Devadatta; and Vrikodara, the doer of fearful deeds, blew his great conch, the Paundra. King Yudhishtira, the son of Kunti, blew his conch, the Anantavijaya; and Nakula and Sahadeva blew the Sughosha and the Manipushpaka. The great archer, the king of Kāśi; the great warrior Śikhāṇḍī; Dhrishtadyumna and Virāṭa; the unconquered Sātyaki; Drupada, and the sons of Draupadi, and the mighty son of Subhadra, O Lord of the Earth, each blew his own conch.

अरिया स घोषो धार्तराष्ट्राणां हृदयानि व्यदारयत् ।
नभश्च पृथिवीं चैव तुमुलोऽभ्यनुनादयन् ॥ 19 ॥

*sa ghoṣho dhārtarāṣṭrāṇām hṛidayāni vyadārayat
nabhaścha prithivīm chaiva tumulo abhyanunādayan*

saḥ—that; **ghoṣhaḥ**—sound; **dhārtarāṣṭrāṇām**—of Dhritarashtra’s sons; **hṛidayāni**—hearts; **vyadārayat**—shattered; **nabhaḥ**—the sky; **cha**—and; **prithivīm**—the earth; **cha**—and; **eva**—certainly; **tumulaḥ**—terrific sound; **abhyanunādayan**—thundering

And that tumult, resounding through heaven and earth, rent the hearts of Dhritarāshtra’s followers.

अथ व्यवस्थितान् दृष्ट्वा धार्तराष्ट्रान् कपिध्वजः ।
प्रवृत्ते शस्त्रसम्पाते धनुरुद्यम्य पाण्डवः ॥ 20 ॥
हृषीकेशं तदा वाक्यमिदमाह महीपते ।

*atha vyavasthitān dṛiṣṭvā dhārtarāṣṭrān kapi-dhwajaḥ
pravṛtte śhastra-sampāte dhanurudyamya pāṇḍavaḥ
hṛiṣhīkeśam tadā vākyaṁ idam āha mahī-pate*

atha—thereupon; **vyavasthitān**—arrayed; **dṛiṣṭvā**—seeing; **dhārtarāṣṭrān**—Dhritarashtra’s sons; **kapi-dwajaḥ**—the monkey bannered; **pravṛtte**—about to commence; **śhastra-sampāte**—to use the weapons; **dhanuḥ**—bow; **udyamya**—taking up; **pāṇḍavaḥ**—Arjun, the son of Pandu; **hṛiṣhīkeśam**—to Shree Krishna; **tadā**—at that time; **vākyaṁ**—words; **idam**—these; **āha**—said; **mahī-pate**—king

O King! Now seeing the Kauravas arrayed in battle order and the discharge of weapons about to begin, Arjuna took up his bow and spoke these words to Lord Krishna.

अर्जुन उवाच ।

सेनयोरुभयोर्मध्ये रथं स्थापय मेऽच्युत ॥ 21 ॥

यावदेतान्निरीक्षेऽहं योद्धुकामानवस्थितान् ।

कैर्मया सह योद्धव्यमस्मिन् रणसमुद्यमे ॥ 22 ॥

arjuna uvācha

senayor ubhayor madhye ratham sthāpaya me 'chyuta

yāvadetan nirīkṣhe 'ham yoddhu-kāmān avasthitān

kairmayā saha yoddhavyam asmin raṇa-samudyame

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **senayoḥ**—armies; **ubhayoḥ**—both; **madhye**—in the middle; **ratham**—chariot; **sthāpaya**—place; **me**—my; **achyuta**—Shree Krishna, the infallible One; **yāvat**—as many as; **etān**—these; **nirīkṣhe**—look; **aham**—I; **yoddhu-kāmān**—for the battle; **avasthitān**—arrayed; **kaiḥ**—with whom; **mayā**—by me; **saha**—together; **yoddhavyam**—must fight; **asmin**—in this; **raṇa-samudyame**—great combat

Arjuna said: O Achyuta, between the two armies draw up my chariot, that I may behold those who stand there eager to fight, and may know, on the eve of battle, with whom I must contend.

योत्स्यमानानवेक्षेऽहं य एतेऽत्र समागताः ।

धार्तराष्ट्रस्य दुर्बुद्धेर्युद्धे प्रियचिकीर्षवः ॥ 23 ॥

yotsyamānān avekṣhe 'ham ya ete 'tra samāgatāḥ

dhārtarāṣṭrasya durbuddher yuddhe priya-chikīrṣhavaḥ

yotsyamānān—those who have come to fight; **avekṣhe aham**—I desire to see; **ye**—who; **ete**—those; **atra**—here; **samāgatāḥ**—assembled; **dhārtarāṣṭrasya**—of Dhritarashtra's son; **durbuddheḥ**—evil-minded; **yuddhe**—in the fight; **priya-chikīrṣhavaḥ**—wishing to please

I would observe these warriors assembled here for the battle wishing to please the evil-minded Duryodhana.

सञ्जय उवाच ।

एवमुक्तो हृषीकेशो गुडाकेशेन भारत ।

सेनयोरुभयोर्मध्ये स्थापयित्वा रथोत्तमम् ॥ 24 ॥

भीष्मद्रोणप्रमुखतः सर्वेषां च महीक्षिताम् ।

उवाच पार्थ पश्यैतान्समवेतान्कुरुनिति ॥ 25 ॥

sañjaya uvācha

evam ukto hṛiṣhīkeśho guḍākeśhena bhārata

senayor ubhayor madhye sthāpayitvā rathottamam

bhīṣhma-droṇa-pramukhataḥ sarveṣhān cha mahī-kṣhitām

uvācha pārtha paśhyaitān samavetān kurūn iti

sañjayah uvācha—Sanjay said; **evam**—thus; **uktaḥ**—addressed; **hṛiṣhīkeśhaḥ**—Shree Krishna, the Lord of the senses; **guḍākeśhena**—by Arjun, the conqueror of sleep; **bhārata**—descendant of Bharat; **senayoh**—armies; **ubhayoh**—the two; **madhye**—between; **sthāpayitvā**—having drawn; **ratha-uttamam**—magnificent chariot; **bhīṣhma**—Grandsire Bheeshma; **droṇa**—Dronacharya; **pramukhataḥ**—in the presence; **sarveṣhām**—all; **cha**—and; **mahī-kṣhitām**—other kings; **uvācha**—said; **pārtha**—Arjun, the son of Pritha; **paśhya**—behold; **etān**—these; **samavetān**—gathered; **kurūn**—descendants of Kuru; **iti**—thus

Sanjaya said: Advised thus by Arjuna Lord Krishna placed the noble chariot in the middle of the two armies, and in front of Bhishma and Drona, and all the Kings, and said: ‘O Arjuna! Behold those Kauravas gathered here.’

तत्रापश्यत्स्थितान् पार्थः पितृ नथ पितामहान् ।
 आचार्यान्मातुलान्भ्रातृ न्पुत्रान्पौत्रान्सखींस्तथा ॥ 26 ॥
 श्वशुरान्सुहृदश्चैव सेनयोरुभयोरपि ।

*tatrāpaśhyat sthitān pārthaḥ pitṛīn atha pitāmahān
 āchāryān mātulān bhrātṛīn putrān pautrān sakhīms tathā
 śhvaśhurān suhṛidaś chaiva senayor ubhayor api*

tatra—there; **apaśhyat**—saw; **sthitān**—stationed; **pārthaḥ**—Arjun; **pitṛīn**—fathers; **atha**—thereafter; **pitāmahān**—grandfathers; **āchāryān**—teachers; **mātulān**—maternal uncles; **bhrātṛīn**—brothers; **putrān**—sons; **pautrān**—grandsons; **sakhīn**—friends; **tathā**—also; **śhvaśhurān**—fathers-in-law; **suhṛidaḥ**—well-wishers; **cha**—and; **eva**—indeed; **senayoḥ**—armies; **ubhayoḥ**—in both armies; **api**—also

There Arjuna saw fathers, grand-fathers, teachers, uncles, brothers, sons, grandsons, companions, fathers-in-law, and friends in both the armies.

तान्समीक्ष्य स कौन्तेयः सर्वान्बन्धूनवस्थितान् ॥ 27 ॥
 कृपया परयाविष्टो विषीदन्निदमब्रवीत् ।

*tān samīkṣhya sa kaunteyaḥ sarvān bandhūn avasthitān
 kṛipayā parayāviṣṭo viṣhīdann idam abravīt*

tān—these; **samīkṣhya**—on seeing; **saḥ**—they; **kaunteyaḥ**—Arjun, the son of Kunti; **sarvān**—all; **bandhūn**—relatives; **avasthitān**—present; **kṛipayā**—by compassion; **parayā**—great; **āviṣṭaḥ**—overwhelmed; **viṣhīdan**—deep sorrow; **idam**—this; **abravīt**—spoke

Casting his eyes on all these kinsmen stationed on opposing sides, the son of Kunti was overcome with deep pity and sorrowfully spoke.

अर्जुन उवाच ।

दृष्ट्वेमं स्वजनं कृष्ण युयुत्सुं समुपस्थितम् ॥ 28 ॥

सीदन्ति मम गात्राणि मुखं च परिशुष्यति ।

वेपथुश्च शरीरे मे रोमहर्षश्च जायते ॥ 29 ॥

गाण्डीवं स्रंसते हस्तात्त्वक्चैव परिदह्यते ।

न च शक्नोम्यवस्थातुं भ्रमतीव च मे मनः ॥ 30 ॥

arjuna uvācha

dr̥ṣṭvemaṁ sva-janaṁ kṛṣṇa yuyutsum samupasthitam

sīdanti mama gātrāṇi mukhaṁ cha pariśuṣhyati

vepathuś cha śharīre me roma-harṣhaś cha jāyate

gāṇḍivam sraṁsate hastāt tvak chaiva paridahyate

na cha śhaknomy avasthātum bhramatīva cha me manaḥ

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **dr̥ṣṭvā**—on seeing; **imam**—these; **sva-janam**—kinsmen; **kṛṣṇa**—Krishna; **yuyutsum**—eager to fight; **samupasthitam**—present; **sīdanti**—quivering; **mama**—my; **gātrāṇi**—limbs; **mukham**—mouth; **cha**—and; **pariśuṣhyati**—is drying up; **vepathuḥ**—shuddering; **cha**—and; **śharīre**—on the body; **me**—my; **roma-harṣhaḥ**—standing of bodily hair on end; **cha**—also; **jāyate**—is happening; **gāṇḍivam**—Arjun's bow; **sraṁsate**—is slipping; **hastāt**—from (my) hand; **tvak**—skin; **cha**—and; **eva**—indeed; **paridahyate**—is burning all over; **na**—not; **cha**—and; **śhaknomy**—am able; **avasthātum**—remain steady; **bhramati iva**—whirling like; **cha**—and; **me**—my; **manaḥ**—mind;

Arjuna said: O Krishna, at the sight of these my kinsmen, assembled here eager to give battle, my limbs fail and my mouth is parched. My body is shaken and my hair stands on end. The bow Gāndiva slips from my hand and my skin is on fire. I cannot hold myself steady; my mind seems to whirl. O Keśava, I see omens of evil.

निमित्तानि च पश्यामि विपरीतानि केशव ।
न च श्रेयोऽनुपश्यामि हत्वा स्वजनमाहवे ॥ 31 ॥

*nimittāni cha paśhyāmi viparītāni keśhava
na cha śhreyo 'nupaśhyāmi hatvā sva-janam āhave*

nimittāni—omens; **cha**—and; **paśhyāmi**—I see; **viparītāni**—misfortune; **keśhava**—Shree Krishna, killer of the Keshi demon; **na**—not; **cha**—also; **śhreyah**—good; **anupaśhyāmi**—I foresee; **hatvā**—from killing; **sva-janam**—kinsmen; **āhave**—in battle

O Krishna! I see many ill-omens and I do not understand what good could come by killing my own people in battle.

न काङ्क्षे विजयं कृष्ण न च राज्यं सुखानि च ।
किं नो राज्येन गोविन्द किं भोगैर्जीवितेन वा ॥ 32 ॥

*na kāṅkṣhe vijayaṁ kṛiṣṇa na cha rājyaṁ sukhāni cha
kiṁ no rājyena govinda kiṁ bhogair jīvitena vā*

na—nor; **kāṅkṣhe**—do I desire; **vijayam**—victory; **kṛiṣṇa**—Krishna; **na**—nor; **cha**—as well; **rājyam**—kingdom; **sukhāni**—happiness; **cha**—also; **kim**—what; **naḥ**—to us; **rājyena**—by kingdom; **govinda**—Krishna, he who gives pleasure to the senses, he who is fond of cows; **kim**—what?; **bhogaiḥ**—pleasures; **jīvitena**—life; **vā**—or;

O Krishna! I do not desire victory or kingdom or pleasures. Of what avail are these kingdom, enjoyment, or even life itself to us.

येषामर्थे काङ्क्षितं नो राज्यं भोगाः सुखानि च ।
त इमेऽवस्थिता युद्धे प्राणांस्त्यक्त्वा धनानि च ॥ 33 ॥
आचार्याः पितरः पुत्रास्तथैव च पितामहाः ।
मातुलाः श्वशुराः पौत्राः श्यालाः सम्बन्धिनस्तथा ॥ 34 ॥

*yeṣhām arthe kāṅkṣhitam no rājyaṁ bhogāḥ sukhāni cha
ta ime 'vasthitā yuddhe prāṇāṁs tyaktvā dhanāni cha
āchāryāḥ pitarāḥ putrās tathaiva cha pitāmahāḥ
mātulāḥ śhvaśhurāḥ pautrāḥ śhyālāḥ sambandhinas tathā*

yeṣhām—for whose; **arthe**—sake; **kāṅkṣhitam**—coveted for; **naḥ**—by us; **rājyam**—kingdom; **bhogāḥ**—pleasures; **sukhāni**—happiness; **cha**—also; **te**—they; **ime**—these; **avasthitāḥ**—situated; **yuddhe**—for battle; **prāṇān**—lives; **tyaktvā**—giving up; **dhanāni**—wealth; **cha**—also; **āchāryāḥ**—teachers; **pitarāḥ**—fathers; **putrāḥ**—sons; **tathā**—as well; **eva**—indeed; **cha**—also; **pitāmahāḥ**—grandfathers; **mātulāḥ**—maternal uncles; **śhvaśhurāḥ**—fathers-in-law; **pautrāḥ**—grandsons; **śhyālāḥ**—brothers-in-law; **sambandhinaḥ**—kinsmen; **tathā**—as well;

Those for whose sake we desire kingdom, enjoyments, and pleasures—teachers, fathers, sons, grandfathers, maternal uncles, fathers-in law, brothers-in-law, grandsons and other relations are all standing here ready for battle, having abandoned their wealth and very life even.

एतान्न हन्तुमिच्छामि घ्नतोऽपि मधुसूदन ।
अपि त्रैलोक्यराज्यस्य हेतोः किं नु महीकृते ॥ 35 ॥

*etān na hantum ichchhāmi ghnato 'pi madhusūdana
api trailokya-rājyasya hetoḥ kim nu mahī-kṛite*

etān—these; **na**—not; **hantum**—to slay; **ichchhāmi**—I wish; **ghnataḥ**—killed; **api**—even though; **madhusūdana**—Shree Krishna, killer of the demon Madhu; **api**—even though; **traī-lokya-rājyasya**—dominion over three worlds; **hetoḥ**—for the sake of; **kim nu**—what to speak of; **mahī-kṛite**—for the earth

These, O Madhusudana, I would not kill, though they should kill me, even for the sake of sovereignty over the three worlds - how much less for this earth!

निहत्य धार्तराष्ट्रान्नः का प्रीतिः स्याज्जनार्दन ।
पापमेवाश्रयेदस्मान्हत्वैतानाततायिनः ॥ 36 ॥

nihatya dhārtarāṣṭhtrān naḥ kā prītiḥ syāj janārdana
pāpam evāśhrayed asmān hatvaitān ātatāyinaḥ

nihatya—by killing; **dhārtarāṣṭhtrān**—the sons of Dhritarashtra; **naḥ**—our; **kā**—what; **prītiḥ**—pleasure; **syāt**—will there be; **janārdana**—he who looks after the public, Shree Krishna; **pāpam**—vices; **eva**—certainly; **āśhrayet**—must come upon; **asmān**—us; **hatvā**—by killing; **etān**—all these; **ātatāyinaḥ**—aggressors;

O Janārdana, what joy can be ours in killing these sons of Dhritarāshtra? Sin alone will possess us if we kill these felons.

तस्मान्नाहं वयं हन्तुं धार्तराष्ट्रान्स्वबान्धवान् ।
स्वजनं हि कथं हत्वा सुखिनः स्याम माधव ॥ 37 ॥

tasmān nārhaḥ vayaṁ hantum dhārtarāṣṭhtrān sa-bāndhavān
sva-janaṁ hi katham hatvā sukhinaḥ syāma mādhaba

tasmāt—hence; **na**—never; **arhāḥ**—behoove; **vayaṁ**—we; **hantum**—to kill; **dhārtarāṣṭhtrān**—the sons of Dhritarashtra; **sva-bāndhavān**—along with friends; **sva-janam**—kinsmen; **hi**—certainly; **katham**—how; **hatvā**—by killing; **sukhinaḥ**—happy; **syāma**—will we become; **mādhava**—Shree Krishna, the husband of Yogmaya

Therefore we ought not to kill our kinsmen, the sons of Dhritarāshtra; for, O Mādhava, how can we ever be happy by killing our own people?

यद्यप्येते न पश्यन्ति लोभोपहतचेतसः ।
कुलक्षयकृतं दोषं मित्रद्रोहे च पातकम् ॥ 38 ॥
कथं न ज्ञेयमस्माभिः पापादस्मान्निवर्तितुम् ।
कुलक्षयकृतं दोषं प्रपश्यद्भिर्जनार्दन ॥ 39 ॥

*yady apy ete na paśhyanti lobhopahata-chetasah
kula-kṣhaya-kṛitam doṣham mitra-drohe cha pātakam
katham na jñeyam asmābhiḥ pāpād asmān nivartitum
kula-kṣhaya-kṛitam doṣham prapaśhyadbhir janārdana*

yadi api—even though; **ete**—they; **na**—not; **paśhyanti**—see; **lobha**—greed; **upahata**—overpowered; **chetasaḥ**—thoughts; **kula-kṣhaya-kṛitam**—in annihilating their relatives; **doṣham**—fault; **mitra-drohe**—to wreak treachery upon friends; **cha**—and; **pātakam**—sin; **katham**—why; **na**—not; **jñeyam**—should be known; **asmābhiḥ**—we; **pāpāt**—from sin; **asmāt**—these; **nivartitum**—to turn away; **kula-kṣhaya**—killing the kindered; **kṛitam**—done; **doṣham**—crime; **prapaśhyadbhiḥ**—who can see; **janārdana**—he who looks after the public, Shree Krishna

Though they, their understanding overcome by greed, perceive no evil in the decay of families and no sin in hostility to friends, why, O Janārdana, should not we, who clearly perceive the evil in the decay of families, learn to refrain from this sin?

कुलक्षये प्रणश्यन्ति कुलधर्माः सनातनाः ।
 धर्मे नष्टे कुलं कृत्स्नमधर्मोऽभिभवत्युत ॥ 40 ॥
 अधर्माभिभवात्कृष्ण प्रदुष्यन्ति कुलस्त्रियः ।
 स्त्रीषु दुष्टासु वार्ष्णेय जायते वर्णसङ्करः ॥ 41 ॥
 सङ्करो नरकायैव कुलघ्नानां कुलस्य च ।
 पतन्ति पितरो ह्येषां लुप्तपिण्डोदकक्रियाः ॥ 42 ॥

*kula-kṣhaye praṇaśhyanti kula-dharmāḥ sanātanāḥ
 dharme naṣṭe kulam kṛitsnam adharmo 'bhibhavaty uta
 adharmābhibhavāt kṛiṣṇa praduṣhyanti kula-striyaḥ
 strīṣhu duṣṭāsu vārṣṇeya jāyate varṇa-saṅkaraḥ
 saṅkaro narakāyaiva kula-ghnānām kulasya cha
 patanti pitaro hy eṣhām lupṭa-piṇḍodaka-kriyāḥ*

kula-kṣhaye—in the destruction of a dynasty; **praṇaśhyanti**—are vanquished; **kula-dharmāḥ**—family traditions; **sanātanāḥ**—eternal; **dharme**—religion; **naṣṭe**—is destroyed; **kulam**—family; **kṛitsnam**—the whole; **adharmāḥ**—irreligion; **abhibhavati**—overcome; **uta**—indeed; **adharma**—irreligion; **abhibhavāt**—preponderance; **kṛiṣṇa**—Shree Krishna; **praduṣhyanti**—become immoral; **kula-striyaḥ**—women of the family; **strīṣhu**—of women; **duṣṭāsu**—immorality; **vārṣṇeya**—descendant of Vrishni; **jāyate**—are born; **varṇa-saṅkaraḥ**—unwanted progeny; **saṅkaraḥ**—unwanted children; **narakāya**—hellish; **eva**—indeed; **kula-ghnānām**—for those who destroy the family; **kulasya**—of the family; **cha**—also; **patanti**—fall; **pitarāḥ**—ancestors; **hi**—verily; **eṣhām**—their; **lupṭa**—deprived of; **piṇḍodaka-kriyāḥ**—performances of sacrificial offerings

With the decay of a family, perish its dharmas, which have existed from time out of mind. With the ending of the dharmas, adharma overwhelms the whole family. When adharma overwhelms the family, O Krishna, the women of the family become corrupt; and when, O Krishna, the women are corrupt, there arises a mixing of castes. This mixture leads into hell the family itself as well as those who destroy it; for their ancestors fall, deprived of the offerings of rice-balls and water.

दोषैरेतैः कुलघ्नानां वर्णसङ्करकारकैः ।
 उत्साद्यन्ते जातिधर्माः कुलधर्माश्च शाश्वताः ॥ 43 ॥
 उत्सन्नकुलधर्माणां मनुष्याणां जनार्दन ।
 नरकेऽनियतं वासो भवतीत्यनुशुश्रुम ॥ 44 ॥

*doṣhair etaiḥ kula-ghnānām varṇa-saṅkara-kārakaiḥ
 utsādyante jāti-dharmāḥ kula-dharmāś cha śhāśhvataḥ
 utsanna-kula-dharmāṇām manuṣhyāṇām janārdana
 narake 'niyataṁ vāso bhavatītyanuśhuśhruma*

doṣhaiḥ—through evil deeds; **etaiḥ**—these; **kula-ghnānām**—of those who destroy the family; **varṇa-saṅkara**—unwanted progeny; **kārakaiḥ**—causing; **utsādyante**—are ruined; **jāti-dharmāḥ**—social and family welfare activities; **kula-dharmāḥ**—family traditions; **cha**—and; **śhāśhvataḥ**—eternal; **utsanna**—destroyed; **kula-dharmāṇām**—whose family traditions; **manuṣhyāṇām**—of such human beings; **janārdana**—he who looks after the public, Shree Krishna; **narake**—in hell; **aniyatam**—indefinite; **vāsaḥ**—dwell; **bhavati**—is; **iti**—thus; **anuśhuśhruma**—I have heard from the learned

By these evil deeds of the destroyers of families, which result in the mixing of castes, the eternal dharmas of caste and family are uprooted. We have heard it said, O Janārdana, that inevitably the men whose family dharmas are destroyed dwell in hell.

अहो बत महत्पापं कर्तुं व्यवसिता वयम् ।
 यद्राज्यसुखलोभेन हन्तुं स्वजनमुद्यताः ॥ 45 ॥

*aho bata mahat pāpaṁ kartuṁ vyavasitā vayam
 yad rājya-sukha-lobhena hantuṁ sva-janam udyatāḥ*

aho—alas; **bata**—horrible results; **mahat**—great; **pāpam**—sins; **kartum**—to perform; **vyavasitāḥ**—have decided; **vayam**—we; **yad**—because; **rājya-sukha-lobhena**—driven by the desire for kingly pleasure; **hantum**—to kill; **sva-janam**—kinsmen; **udyatāḥ**—intending;

Alas, we are resolved to commit a great sin, in that we are ready to slay our kinsmen to satisfy our greed for the pleasure of a kingdom!

यदि मामप्रतीकारमशस्त्रं शस्त्रपाणयः ।
धार्तराष्ट्रा रणे हन्युस्तन्मे क्षेमतरं भवेत् ॥ 46 ॥

*yadi mām apratikāram aśhastram śhastra-pāṇayaḥ
dhārtarāṣṭrā raṇe hanyus tan me kṣhemataram bhavet*

yadi—if; mām—me; apratikāram—unresisting; aśhastram—unarmed; śhastra-pāṇayaḥ—those with weapons in hand; dhārtarāṣṭrāḥ—the sons of Dhritarashtra; raṇe—on the battlefield; hanyuḥ—shall kill; tat—that; me—to me; kṣhema-taram—better; bhavet—would be

Far better would it be for me if the sons of Dhritarāshtra, weapons in hand, should slay me in the battle, unarmed and unresisting.

सञ्जय उवाच ।
एवमुक्त्वार्जुनः सङ्ख्ये रथोपस्थ उपाविशत् ।
विसृज्य सशरं चापं शोकसंविग्नमानसः ॥ 47 ॥

*sañjaya uvācha
evam uktvārjunaḥ saṅkhye rathopastha upāviśat
visṛjya sa-śharam chāpaṁ śhoka-saṁvigna-mānasah*

sañjayaḥ uvācha—Sanjay said; evam uktvā—speaking thus; arjunaḥ—Arjun; saṅkhye—in the battlefield; ratha upasthe—on the chariot; upāviśat—sat; visṛjya—casting aside; sa-śharam—along with arrows; chāpam—the bow; śhoka—with grief; saṁvigna—distressed; mānasah—mind

Sanjaya said: Arjuna, having spoken thus on the battlefield, cast aside his bow and arrow and sank down on his chariot-seat, his mind overcome with grief.